Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-10

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Amos 5:1-6

1 Hear this word which I take up against you, a lamentation, O house of Israel:

2 The virgin of Israel has fallen; She will rise no more. She lies forsaken on her land; There is no one to raise her up.

3 For thus says the Lord GOD: "The city that goes out by a thousand Shall have a hundred left, And that which goes out by a hundred Shall have ten left to the house of Israel."

4 For thus says the LORD to the house of Israel: "Seek Me and live;

5 But do not seek Bethel, Nor enter Gilgal, Nor pass over to Beersheba; For Gilgal shall surely go into captivity, And Bethel shall come to nothing.

6 Seek the LORD and live, Lest He break out like fire in the house of Joseph, And devour it, With no one to quench it in Bethel—

II. Key Summary

• Amos takes up a lamentation for the house of Israel: the virgin of Israel has fallen and will rise no more; she lies forsaken on her land with no one to raise her up. A city that goes out by a thousand shall have a hundred left, and one that goes out by a hundred shall have ten left (vv. 1–3).

• The LORD says to the house of Israel, "Seek Me and live," and tells them not to seek Bethel, not to enter Gilgal, and not to pass over to Beersheba, for Gilgal shall go into captivity and Bethel shall come to nothing (vv. 4–5).

• Verse 6 says it again, "Seek the LORD and live," lest He break out like fire in the house of Joseph, with no one to quench it in Bethel.

III. Passage Analysis

"Seek Me and Live"

> The prophet urges the people to seek God sincerely, rather than going to Bethel, Gilgal, or Beersheba to offer sacrifices. The people thought that offering sacrifices at these places was seeking God, because God had appeared to their forefathers at these places (Gen 26:23-25; 28:10-22; 46:1-4). [1]

In the previous passage (4:4) the Lord said, "Come to Bethel and transgress, at Gilgal multiply transgression"; here (vv. 4–5) He says, "Seek Me," and right after that, "do not seek Bethel, nor enter Gilgal, nor pass over to Beersheba."

What the LORD wants the house of Israel to seek is Himself.

"With No One to Quench It in Bethel"

> But God tells them that when the fire of his judgments should kindle upon them all the gods they served at Bethel should not be able to quench it, should not turn away the judgment, nor be any relief to them under it. [2]

Verse 5 says Bethel "shall come to nothing," and verse 6 says the fire will burn "with no one to quench it in Bethel." The Bethel they went to seek could not even save itself.

The same verse opens with the way to life: "Seek the LORD and live."

IV. Reflection Question

When something really stresses you out or scares you, what is the first thing you run to seek? What did you find there?

Israel went to seek Bethel, Gilgal, and Beersheba; God said Bethel "shall come to nothing," and said twice, "Seek the LORD and live."

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), Chain-Reference Bible Commentary (串珠聖經註釋), Amos 5 notes, https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT05.htm

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary (Amos 5), https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/Amo/Amo_005.cfm